

Eugenics and Scientific Racism

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Eugenics, coined by Francis Galton is an ideology or process which tries to enhance genetic fitness of humans ~~is~~ by allowing only "desirable" genotypes & phenotypes to reproduce.

Scientific racism & relation with Eugenics

Rediscovery of Mendelian laws & eugenics led to scientific racism due to simplistic understanding of human inheritance.

- 1) Francis Galton advocated for laws against racial intermixing to prevent the emergence of a 'mediocre' population.
- 2) Charles Davenport in his 'Principles of Eugenics' highlighted racial intermixing will lead to segregation of undesirable traits.

3.) American Breeders association aimed at spreading awareness about ~~Eugenics~~

4.) Indiana became first U.S. state to implement Johnson Red Law that prevented intermixing (1917)

These provided support to the racism on scientific basis.

Refuting Eugenics

① Frans Boas on the basis of study of 18000 Japanese immigrant Gothic index in U.S highlighted these features depend on environment

② Lewontin highlighted only 5-10% of genetic differences can be attributed to racial differences

③ finally Human genome project revealed 99.9% of human DNA is similar & pure races do not exist.

Thus, Eugenics & scientific racism has slowly lost their ground.

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